

Minutes of Meeting

Meeting Details

Date: April 8, 2026 (Wednesday)

Time: 4:00 PM

Platform: Online Conference

Attendees

Client Team:

- Manish Ranjan

Student Team:

- Vikesh
- Advait
- Amish
- Keshav
- Venya

Meeting Agenda

- Discussion on safety guardrails for self-harm detection
- Privacy-preserving handling of patient data (PII removal)
- Progress towards final system readiness
- Planning for final demo and possible offline meeting

1. Safety Guardrails Implementation

- The student team presented the current implementation of safety guardrails using a **pre-processing interception layer**.
- The system uses **regular expression-based pattern matching** to detect phrases related to self-harm or crisis situations (e.g., “want to die”, “kill myself”).
- The **check_safety()** function evaluates user input before it reaches the core system (RAG/LLM pipeline).
- Upon detection:
 - The system immediately triggers a **hardcoded crisis response**.
 - The AI pipeline is **completely bypassed**.
 - Emergency helpline information is returned instantly.
- The client acknowledged the implementation and suggested further research into **more robust and scalable guardrail mechanisms**.

2. Privacy and PII Protection

- The client emphasized the importance of **strict patient data privacy**.
- Key requirement:
 - **No personally identifiable information (PII)** should be sent to any external model or API.
- The team discussed implementing **PII removal locally** using:
 - NLP-based approaches
 - Rule-based or pattern-based filtering
- It was explicitly noted that:
 - Using external models for PII removal is **not allowed** due to privacy concerns.
- The client suggested further **research into de-identification techniques** to ensure compliance and robustness.

3. Project Progress and Finalization

- The client expressed **positive feedback** regarding the current progress and direction of the project.
- The discussion focused on moving towards a **final production-ready system**.
- The team is expected to:
 - Integrate safety mechanisms
 - Ensure privacy compliance
 - Improve system stability and response quality

4. Final Demo Planning

- The client suggested the possibility of conducting the **next meeting offline**.
- Objective:
 - Provide a **complete demonstration of the system**
 - Showcase all implemented features in detail
- The student team is expected to prepare:
 - End-to-end working system
 - Clear explanation of architecture and design decisions
 - Demonstration of safety and privacy mechanisms

5. Action Items

Action Item	Owner	Description	Deadline
PII Removal Module	Student Team	Develop local NLP-based pipeline for removing sensitive patient information before model processing	Next Meeting
System Integration	Student Team	Integrate safety, privacy, and core chatbot functionalities into a unified system	Next Meeting
Prepare Final Demo	Student Team	Prepare complete system demonstration including architecture explanation and live execution	Next Meeting
Review Implementation	Client	Review progress and provide feedback during next meeting (possibly offline)	Next Meeting

6. Next Meeting Goals

- Demonstrate a **fully functional healthcare chatbot system**
- Ensure:
 - Proper safety guardrails
 - Privacy-preserving data handling
 - Accurate and relevant responses
- Conduct a **detailed walkthrough of system architecture and implementation**